

The negotiator's dilemma and generating options

Day 3 · Session 1 | Both sectors | Shared resource

This worksheet opens Day 3. Keep it for this afternoon's Job Grading role-play and Thursday's sector simulations.

The Negotiator's Dilemma

Creating Value (Cooperative)	Claiming Value (Competitive)
Sharing information openly about interests and priorities Working jointly to expand what's possible before dividing anything Risk: can be exploited by a purely competitive counterpart	Securing the largest possible share of what's on the table Withholding information, using leverage, timing and alternatives Risk: too much of this shrinks the pie before it's divided

Three Forces That Shape Which Game You Can Play

Force	Detail
Trust	Enables honest disclosure; built through small kept commitments; asymmetric to lose
Power	Comes from alternatives, resources, time, authority to decide; changes what you can claim, not what is fair
Information	Who knows what shapes who can claim what; withholding protects a position, sharing enables joint value

Building and Eroding Trust at the Table

Do	Don't
Do what you said you would do, on small matters especially Share the reasoning behind a position, not only the position Acknowledge the other side's genuine constraints Separate what you cannot agree to from what you cannot discuss	Make a commitment you're not confident you can keep Misrepresent anything that can later be checked Treat past broken promises as ancient history Use something disclosed in confidence as leverage later

Self-Assessment

Answer honestly — there is no "correct" score. The goal is awareness.

Prompt	Your honest answer
In a typical negotiation, do you lean more toward creating value or claiming it?	
Where do you usually sit on power — more, less, or roughly equal to the other side?	
What information do you tend to over-share, or over-withhold, by habit?	
One thing you will deliberately try differently in this afternoon's role-play	

Generating Options: When Scope Exists — and When It Doesn't

Separate inventing options from deciding on them — generate first, judge later

Go for quantity; build on ideas rather than critiquing them as they form

Write every option down; look for one that costs one side little but is worth a lot to the other

Recognizing that an issue is genuinely distributive — a single number, a fixed pot, nothing else on the table — is not a lack of creativity. Brainstorming cannot invent a second dimension that isn't there.

Brainstorm Worksheet — The Parking Allocation

A site has forty staff parking spaces and around seventy staff who drive to work. Staff have asked for a fixed, named allocation; management has refused. Real scope exists here — do not re-argue the needs below, use them.

Underlying need	Detail
Staff side	Predictability for colleagues on early/late shifts with no safe transport option at those hours
Management	Avoiding a permanent entitlement that cannot be revisited when the site layout changes next year

No.	Option (write every idea — no evaluation yet)
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	

Most promising option	Why — and what it costs one side vs. what it's worth to the other
Option A	
Option B	

Looking Ahead

Question 1
Job Grading launches at 11:00 today; the live negotiation starts at 14:00 after lunch. Which approach, question or option-generating habit will you try?